

**SENIOR SCHOOL LEARNER'S NOTES**  
BASED ON THE KICD GRADE 10 CURRICULUM DESIGN

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# ENGLISH

## GRADE 10 • SENIOR SCHOOL

*A Learner's Textbook for Students Aged 14–16*

*Covering: Listening & Speaking | Reading | Grammar in Use | Writing*

*Includes Idea Boxes, Case Studies, Reflection Questions, Quick Checks, Worksheets and a Complete Answer Key*

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## HOW TO USE THIS BOOK

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This textbook is organised into four topics, matching the Grade 10 English curriculum: Listening and Speaking, Reading, Grammar in Use, and Writing. Each topic is divided into sub-topics containing the following features to support your learning:

- Learning Outcomes — what you should be able to do by the end of the sub-topic.
- Key Inquiry Question — a guiding question to think about as you study.
- Idea Box — an interesting fact related to the sub-topic.
- Case Study — a real-life example, often from Kenya, showing how the English skills you are learning apply in real life.
- Reflection — an open question for you to think about or discuss; there is no single 'correct' answer.
- Quick Check — short questions to test your understanding immediately after each sub-topic.
- End of Topic Review Questions — a longer set of questions covering the whole topic.
- Practical Worksheet — a hands-on activity to help you apply what you have learnt.

This book weaves in the nine curriculum themes — Etiquette, Environment, Technology, Travel, Careers, Culture, Sports and Games, Health and Safety, and Income — through its examples and case studies, so that you practise English in real, meaningful contexts.

All answers to the Quick Check and End of Topic Review Questions are provided in the Answer Key chapter at the very end of this book. Always attempt the questions on your own first before checking your answers — this is how you build strong understanding.

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## CURRICULUM THEMES

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The Grade 10 English curriculum uses the following nine real-life themes as contexts for learning. You will notice these themes appearing throughout the examples, case studies and worksheets in this book.

- Etiquette
- Environment
- Technology
- Travel
- Careers
- Culture
- Sports and Games
- Health and Safety
- Income: Types and Sources

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**TOPIC 1****LISTENING AND SPEAKING**

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Listening and speaking are the foundation of everyday communication. In this topic you will learn different listening strategies, how to read non-verbal cues, how to pronounce English sounds correctly, and how to speak fluently and appropriately in different social and professional situations — from etiquette at a hotel to conducting a meeting.

## 1.1 Types of Listening

Suggested Lessons: 22

**Key Inquiry Question:** *How can one gain the most through listening, and how do different listening strategies help us in different situations?*

By the end of this sub-topic, you should be able to:

- describe characters, places and events from a recording (extensive listening)
- pick key details from an oral text for general or specific information (intensive/selective listening)
- evaluate a speaker's message and point of view (critical listening)
- respond appropriately to what is heard in a conversation (interactive/responsive listening)
- appreciate the value of different listening strategies for lifelong learning

### Why Listening Matters

Listening is not simply hearing sounds — it is an active process of receiving, interpreting and responding to spoken messages. Good listeners understand more, learn faster, and build stronger relationships. English 'Listening and Speaking' skills are tested and used throughout your life: in class, in interviews, in meetings and in everyday conversation.

### Types of Listening and When to Use Them

| Type of Listening     | Purpose                                                                                    | Example Situation                                                |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Extensive listening   | Listening for overall enjoyment and general understanding of characters, places and events | Listening to a story, a dialogue or a recorded skit              |
| Intensive listening   | Listening closely to pick out specific detailed information                                | Listening to a news bulletin to note down exact figures or names |
| Selective listening   | Filtering out unnecessary information and focusing only on what is needed                  | Listening for your flight number at an airport announcement      |
| Critical listening    | Evaluating the message, identifying the speaker's opinion, bias, or purpose                | Listening to a political speech or an advertisement              |
| Interactive listening | Listening and responding within a two-way conversation                                     | A conversation, an interview, or a discussion                    |
| Responsive listening  | Listening carefully then giving thoughtful feedback or a suitable response                 | Listening to a friend's problem and offering advice              |

### Strategies for Effective Listening

- Focus your attention on the speaker and avoid distractions
- Listen for key words and signal phrases (e.g. 'firstly', 'however', 'in conclusion')
- Take brief notes of important details as you listen
- Avoid interrupting; wait for natural pauses to ask questions
- Reflect on what has been said before responding

#### Did You Know?

Research shows that most people only remember about 25–50% of what they hear immediately after listening! Practising active listening strategies — like note-taking and mentally summarising — greatly

*improves how much you retain.*

### **Case Study: Listening in the World of Careers**

During a job interview, an interviewer often gauges a candidate's listening skills as much as their answers. A candidate who listens critically can pick out exactly what is being asked, respond directly, and even notice unspoken cues about what the interviewer values most — such as teamwork or punctuality.

#### **Discussion Questions:**

1. Which type of listening would be most useful during a job interview, and why?
2. Describe a time when poor listening caused a misunderstanding. What listening strategy could have prevented it?

### **REFLECTION — Think About It**

*Think of a recent conversation where you had to listen carefully. Which type of listening did you use, and how did it help you respond appropriately?*

### **Quick Check 1.1**

1. Distinguish between extensive listening and intensive listening.
2. Give one real-life example of selective listening.
3. Why is critical listening important when watching an advertisement?
4. State two strategies for effective listening.

## 1.2 Non-Verbal Communication Cues

Suggested Lessons: 3

**Key Inquiry Question:** *How do non-verbal cues affect the meaning of a spoken message?*

By the end of this sub-topic, you should be able to:

- identify various non-verbal cues used in communication
- interpret the meaning conveyed by non-verbal cues in different contexts
- use appropriate non-verbal cues to enhance communication
- appreciate the role of non-verbal cues in effective communication

### What Are Non-Verbal Cues?

Non-verbal cues are the ways we communicate without using words. Studies suggest that a large proportion of meaning in face-to-face communication comes from non-verbal signals rather than the words themselves.

- Facial expressions — smiling, frowning, raised eyebrows
- Gestures — hand movements, nodding, pointing
- Eye contact — showing attentiveness, confidence or respect
- Posture and body orientation — standing tall shows confidence; slouching may show disinterest
- Proxemics (use of space) — how close or far apart people stand
- Tone of voice and pace — even without words, tone conveys emotion

### Using Non-Verbal Cues Appropriately

Non-verbal cues should match the spoken message and the cultural context. For example, direct eye contact is seen as respectful in some cultures but disrespectful to elders in others. Being aware of your audience helps you use non-verbal cues appropriately.

#### Did You Know?

*Crossed arms are often read as a sign of defensiveness or disagreement, while an open posture with uncrossed arms signals openness and confidence — even before a single word is spoken!*

#### REFLECTION — Think About It

*Describe a situation where someone's body language told you something different from what they were saying. Which message did you trust more, and why?*

#### Quick Check 1.2

1. Define the term 'non-verbal cues'.
2. List three examples of non-verbal cues used in communication.
3. Explain why eye contact might mean different things in different cultures.



## 1.3 Sounds and Pronunciation

Suggested Lessons: 16

**Key Inquiry Question:** *Why is accurate pronunciation important for effective communication?*

By the end of this sub-topic, you should be able to:

- articulate target English vowel and consonant sounds correctly
- place stress correctly in words (syllabic stress) and in sentences (emphatic stress)
- distinguish word classes on the basis of stress patterns
- justify the need for accurate pronunciation in communication

### Key Sounds to Master

| Sound(s)     | Example Words             | Tip for Articulation                                                        |
|--------------|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| /ɒ/ and /ɔ:/ | hot (/ɒ/), thought (/ɔ:/) | /ɒ/ is short and sharp; /ɔ:/ is longer with rounded lips                    |
| /ʊ/ and /u:/ | book (/ʊ/), food (/u:/)   | /ʊ/ is short; /u:/ is longer, lips more rounded and pushed forward          |
| /i:/         | sheep, sea, machine       | Keep the sound long — confusing it with /ɪ/ (as in 'ship') changes meaning! |
| /f/          | father, phase, rough      | Notice that /f/ can be spelt as 'f', 'ph' or 'gh'                           |
| /ŋ/ and /ŋg/ | sing (/ŋ/), finger (/ŋg/) | /ŋ/ is a single nasal sound; /ŋg/ adds a hard 'g' sound after it            |

### Word Stress (Syllabic Stress)

Some English words change their word class — and meaning — depending on which syllable is stressed. This is common in two-syllable words that can be both a noun and a verb.

| Word    | As a Noun (stress on 1st syllable) | As a Verb (stress on 2nd syllable) |
|---------|------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| record  | RE-cord (a music record)           | re-CORD (to record a video)        |
| convict | CON-vict (a prisoner)              | con-VICT (to find guilty)          |
| produce | PRO-duce (farm produce)            | pro-DUCE (to make something)       |
| rebel   | REB-el (a fighter)                 | re-BEL (to resist authority)       |

### Sentence (Emphatic) Stress

Emphatic stress is placing extra stress on a particular word in a sentence to emphasise its importance or change the meaning. For example: 'I did not take your book' can mean different things depending on which word is stressed (I, did, not, your, book).

### Sense Relations

- Synonyms — words with similar meaning, e.g. happy/glad
- Antonyms — words with opposite meaning, e.g. hot/cold
- Homophones — words that sound the same but have different meanings/spelling, e.g. sea/see, flower/flour

**Did You Know?**

There are over 40 distinct sounds (phonemes) in English, but only 26 letters in the alphabet! This is why the same letter combination can be pronounced differently in different words, e.g. 'though', 'through' and 'tough'.

**REFLECTION — Think About It**

Think of a word in your own language that changes meaning when the stress or tone changes. How is this similar to word stress in English?

**Quick Check 1.3**

1. Give one example of a word whose meaning changes depending on where the stress falls.
2. Distinguish between a synonym, an antonym and a homophone, giving one example of each.
3. Practise saying: 'sheep' and 'ship'. Explain the difference in the vowel sound.

## 1.4 Conversational Skills and Etiquette

Suggested Lessons: 15

**Key Inquiry Question:** *Why is it important to observe etiquette and good conversational skills in different social and professional contexts?*

By the end of this sub-topic, you should be able to:

- use appropriate etiquette in different contexts (hotel, market, telephone, meetings)
- apply techniques for changing topics and giving/receiving feedback in a conversation
- conduct and participate in a meeting appropriately
- value the role of etiquette and conversational skills in effective communication

### Etiquette in Different Contexts

Etiquette refers to the accepted, polite way of behaving in a given social or professional situation. Different situations call for different levels of formality.

| Context                      | Examples of Good Etiquette                                                                          |
|------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Telephone conversations      | Greet politely, identify yourself, speak clearly, avoid interrupting, end politely                  |
| Hotel/customer service       | Use polite requests ('Could you please...'), thank the attendant, avoid rudeness even when unhappy  |
| Market/business transactions | Greet the seller, negotiate respectfully, say thank you regardless of outcome                       |
| School/formal settings       | Address teachers and adults respectfully, raise your hand before speaking, listen when others speak |

### Techniques for Changing the Topic and Giving Feedback

- Changing the topic politely: 'By the way...', 'That reminds me...', 'On a different note...'
- Giving feedback constructively: focus on the message, not the person; be specific; suggest improvement
- Receiving feedback graciously: listen fully before responding; thank the speaker; ask clarifying questions

### Conducting and Participating in Meetings

A well-run meeting follows a structure: the chairperson calls the meeting to order, previous minutes are read and confirmed, the agenda is followed point by point, and action points are recorded before the meeting is closed. Participants should speak when recognised by the chair, stick to the agenda, and be respectful of differing opinions.

#### Did You Know?

*In many professional settings, arriving even five minutes early for a meeting is considered good etiquette — while arriving late without notice can be seen as disrespecting everyone else's time!*

#### Case Study: Etiquette in the Hospitality Industry

Kenya's tourism and hospitality sector depends heavily on staff who observe excellent etiquette — from the way a hotel receptionist answers the phone to how a waiter addresses a difficult customer. Hotels in destinations like Diani, Maasai Mara and Nairobi train staff specifically in verbal and non-verbal etiquette because a guest's overall experience, and the hotel's reputation and repeat business, depend on it.

#### Discussion Questions:

1. Role play a conversation between a hotel receptionist and a guest who is unhappy about their room. Use polite

language throughout.

2. Explain why poor etiquette in customer service could affect a business's income.

 **REFLECTION — Think About It**

*Describe a time when someone's good (or poor) etiquette affected how you felt about a conversation or service you received.*

 **Quick Check 1.4**

1. State two examples of good telephone etiquette.
2. Give one polite phrase you could use to change the topic in a conversation.
3. Outline the basic structure followed in conducting a formal meeting.

## 1.5 Speaking Fluency

Suggested Lessons: 7

**Key Inquiry Question:** *How can we tell a story or share information accurately, expressively and at the right speed?*

**By the end of this sub-topic, you should be able to:**

- narrate stories, dialogues or information fluently and expressively
- use appropriate sense relations (synonyms, antonyms, homophones) to enhance speech
- adjust speed, tone and expression to suit the audience and purpose
- appreciate the value of speaking fluency in effective communication

### What Is Speaking Fluency?

Speaking fluency means being able to speak smoothly, accurately, expressively and at an appropriate pace without unnecessary pauses, hesitations or repeated words (fillers like 'um' or 'ah').

### Tips for Improving Speaking Fluency

- Practise speaking regularly, even by reading aloud
- Organise your thoughts briefly before speaking
- Use varied vocabulary — synonyms help avoid repeating the same word
- Match your pace to your audience — slower for complex ideas, natural pace for casual conversation
- Use appropriate facial expression and tone to match the content



#### Did You Know?

Professional news anchors and public speakers often practise 'tongue twisters' before speaking in public — sentences that are deliberately difficult to say quickly and clearly — to warm up their articulation muscles!



#### REFLECTION — Think About It

Think about a time you had to speak in front of a group. What made you feel confident, or what made it difficult to speak fluently?



#### Quick Check 1.5

1. Define speaking fluency in your own words.
2. State two strategies you could use to improve your speaking fluency.
3. Why is varying your vocabulary (using synonyms) important when speaking?

## End of TOPIC 1 Review Questions

Answer all questions. Refer to the Answer Key chapter at the end of this book to check your work after attempting all questions on your own.

1. Distinguish between extensive listening and critical listening, giving an example of each.
2. Explain why selective listening is a useful skill in a noisy environment such as a market or airport.
3. Define non-verbal cues and give three examples.
4. Explain why the same non-verbal cue may be interpreted differently in different cultures.
5. Distinguish between the vowel sounds /ɒ/ and /ɔ:/, giving one example word for each.
6. Explain how word stress can change a word from a noun to a verb, using one example.
7. Distinguish between a synonym, an antonym and a homophone.
8. State three examples of good etiquette to observe during a telephone conversation.
9. Outline the correct structure for conducting a formal meeting.
10. Give two techniques for changing the topic politely during a conversation.
11. Explain what is meant by 'speaking fluency' and state two ways to improve it.
12. A candidate is preparing for a job interview. Advise them on two listening skills and two speaking skills they should apply during the interview.

## Topic 1 Practical Worksheet: Listening and Speaking in Action

Work in pairs. One learner will read aloud a short passage (provided by your teacher or chosen from a newspaper) about one of the following themes: Careers, Travel, or Health and Safety, while the other listens and takes notes.

### Tasks:

1. The listener should identify and write down five key details from the passage (intensive listening).
2. Swap roles and repeat with a different short passage.
3. In pairs, role-play a telephone conversation booking a hotel room, observing proper etiquette throughout.
4. Practise saying the following pairs aloud, focusing on correct vowel sounds: sheep/ship, full/fool, hot/thought.
5. Prepare and deliver a one-minute spoken narration on 'An Interesting Journey I Have Taken', focusing on fluency, expression and appropriate pace. Ask a partner to give you constructive feedback.

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**TOPIC 2****READING**

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Reading well is one of the most powerful tools for learning. In this topic you will develop reading fluency, learn to read widely for pleasure and information (extensive reading), read closely for detail (intensive reading), build study skills, and read critically to evaluate what you read.

## 2.1 Reading Fluency

Suggested Lessons: 8

**Key Inquiry Question:** *How can one read a text accurately, expressively and at the right speed?*

By the end of this sub-topic, you should be able to:

- read a text accurately, expressively and at an appropriate speed
- determine how words are used together to enhance meaning (collocations and binomials)
- value reading fluency for effective communication

### What Is Reading Fluency?

Reading fluency is the ability to read a text accurately (correct words), at an appropriate speed (not too slow or rushed), and expressively (with correct emphasis, tone and pauses that reflect meaning and punctuation).

### Collocations and Binomials

Fluent readers and writers recognise words that are commonly used together (collocations), which helps them read faster and understand meaning more naturally.

| Pattern                      | Example                                          |
|------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| Adverb + Adjective           | completely satisfied, deeply concerned           |
| Adjective + Noun             | excruciating pain, heavy rainfall                |
| Noun + Noun                  | a surge of anger, a wave of excitement           |
| Binomials (fixed word pairs) | bread and butter, safe and sound, back and forth |

### Improving Reading Fluency

- Practise reading aloud regularly, paying attention to punctuation
- Read a passage more than once to build speed and confidence
- Notice collocations and binomials rather than reading word by word
- Record yourself reading and listen back to check expressiveness

#### Did You Know?

Fluent adult readers typically read at 200–300 words per minute silently while still understanding what they read. Reading fluency is not about racing — it is about accuracy, speed and expression working together!

#### REFLECTION — Think About It

Think of a time you struggled to read a text fluently. What made it difficult — speed, unfamiliar words, or expression? What could help you improve?

#### Quick Check 2.1

1. Define reading fluency.
2. Give one example each of an adverb+adjective collocation and a noun+noun collocation.
3. Explain why practising reading aloud can improve fluency.



## 2.2 Extensive Reading

Suggested Lessons: 8

**Key Inquiry Question:** *How can one make predictions about the content of a text before reading it fully?*

By the end of this sub-topic, you should be able to:

- preview a text and make predictions about its content using titles and images
- read widely for general understanding and enjoyment
- use signal words such as connectors and conjunctions to follow a text
- appreciate extensive reading as a tool for lifelong learning

### What Is Extensive Reading?

Extensive reading means reading widely and often — books, newspapers, magazines, blogs — mainly for overall understanding, enjoyment and general knowledge, rather than studying every word closely.

### Making Predictions Before Reading

Good readers preview a text before reading it fully. This means looking at the title, headings, photographs, graphs and the first sentence of paragraphs to predict what the text will be about. This activates prior knowledge and improves comprehension.

### Using Signal Words

Signal words (connectors and conjunctions) guide the reader through a text's structure and logic.

| Type of Signal | Examples                             | What It Signals              |
|----------------|--------------------------------------|------------------------------|
| Addition       | furthermore, in addition, also       | More information is coming   |
| Contrast       | however, on the other hand, although | A different or opposing idea |
| Cause/effect   | therefore, as a result, consequently | A result or consequence      |
| Sequence       | firstly, then, finally               | Order of events or ideas     |

#### Did You Know?

*Studies consistently show that students who read extensively for pleasure — even just 20 minutes a day — develop significantly larger vocabularies and stronger writing skills than those who read only textbooks.*

#### Case Study: Reading for Travel and Adventure

Before travelling to a new destination, seasoned travellers often read travel blogs, brochures and guidebooks extensively to get a general feel for the place — culture, weather, must-see sites — without needing to memorise every detail. This is a real-life example of extensive reading in action.

#### Discussion Questions:

1. Preview the title and any images of a travel brochure your teacher provides. What predictions can you make about its content?
2. Explain how extensive reading before a trip could help a traveller stay safe and prepared.

#### REFLECTION — Think About It

*What kinds of texts (books, blogs, magazines) do you enjoy reading extensively? How has reading them*

*widened your knowledge or vocabulary?*

 **Quick Check 2.2**

1. Define extensive reading.
2. Explain how previewing a text's title and images can help a reader.
3. Give an example of a signal word that shows contrast, and one that shows sequence.

## 2.3 Intensive Reading

Suggested Lessons: 8

**Key Inquiry Question:** *How do we pick out specific and detailed information from a text?*

By the end of this sub-topic, you should be able to:

- read a text closely to extract specific and detailed information
- interpret vocabulary and structures within their context
- answer detailed comprehension questions based on a text
- appreciate intensive reading as a way of understanding a text deeply

### What Is Intensive Reading?

Unlike extensive reading, intensive reading involves reading a shorter text very closely and carefully to understand specific details, vocabulary, grammar structures and the writer's exact meaning. It is the kind of reading you do for a comprehension exercise or when studying a set text.

### Strategies for Intensive Reading

- Read the text more than once — first for overall meaning, then closely for detail
- Underline or note unfamiliar words and try to work out their meaning from context
- Identify the main idea of each paragraph
- Answer comprehension questions by referring back to the exact part of the text
- Pay attention to how pronouns (he, it, this, they) refer back to earlier ideas



#### Did You Know?

You can often guess the meaning of an unfamiliar word without a dictionary by looking at 'context clues' — the words and sentences around it — such as a definition, an example, or a contrast word like 'but' or 'unlike'.



#### REFLECTION — Think About It

Describe a difficult text you had to read closely (intensively) for school. What strategy helped you understand it better?



#### Quick Check 2.3

1. Distinguish between extensive reading and intensive reading.
2. Explain one strategy for working out the meaning of an unfamiliar word from context.
3. Why is it important to identify the main idea of each paragraph during intensive reading?

## 2.4 Study Skills

Suggested Lessons: 8

**Key Inquiry Question:** *What skills help a learner study and research effectively?*

By the end of this sub-topic, you should be able to:

- apply skimming and scanning techniques when reading
- take organised notes from a text
- use print and digital resources (library, internet) responsibly for research
- appreciate the value of good study skills for lifelong learning

### Skimming and Scanning

| Technique | Purpose                                         | How To Do It                                                               |
|-----------|-------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Skimming  | Getting the general idea of a text quickly      | Read titles, headings, first and last sentences of paragraphs              |
| Scanning  | Finding a specific piece of information quickly | Move your eyes quickly over the text looking for a keyword, date or number |

### Note-Taking Skills

- Use headings and sub-headings to organise notes
- Use bullet points or numbering rather than full sentences
- Use abbreviations and symbols consistently (e.g. 'e.g.', '&', '→')
- Highlight or underline key terms

### Using Research Resources Responsibly

Whether using library books or internet sources, always evaluate the reliability of the source, record where information came from (for referencing), and avoid copying text directly (plagiarism) — rephrase ideas in your own words.



#### Did You Know?

Skimming a whole chapter can take less than 2 minutes, yet it can help you decide whether the chapter is relevant to your research — saving hours of unnecessary intensive reading!



#### REFLECTION — Think About It

Which study skill (skimming, scanning or note-taking) do you find most useful, and how could you apply it better in your revision?



#### Quick Check 2.4

1. Distinguish between skimming and scanning.
2. State two good note-taking practices.
3. Explain why it is important to record the source of information used in research.

## 2.5 Critical Reading

Suggested Lessons: 4

**Key Inquiry Question:** *How can a reader evaluate the reliability and viewpoint of a text?*

By the end of this sub-topic, you should be able to:

- distinguish between fact and opinion in a text
- identify a writer's viewpoint, purpose and possible bias
- evaluate the reliability of information in a text
- appreciate critical reading as a tool for informed decision-making

### What Is Critical Reading?

Critical reading goes beyond understanding what a text says — it means questioning why it says it, who wrote it, and whether it is reliable and fair. This is an essential skill in a world full of information, including misinformation, on social media and the internet.

### Fact vs Opinion

| Fact                                    | Opinion                                                |
|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Can be proven true or false             | Reflects a personal belief or judgement                |
| E.g. 'Kenya is located in East Africa.' | E.g. 'Kenya has the most beautiful scenery in Africa.' |

### Identifying Bias and Purpose

- Ask: Who wrote this, and why?
- Look for emotionally loaded language that tries to persuade rather than inform
- Check whether only one side of an argument is presented
- Cross-check surprising claims with another reliable source

#### Did You Know?

*Critical reading skills are especially important online — studies show many people share news articles based only on the headline, without reading (let alone critically evaluating) the full article!*

#### Case Study: Evaluating Health Information Online

During a health awareness campaign, two articles circulate online about a new health product. One is written by a certified doctor citing medical studies; the other is written by an anonymous blogger with no sources, using dramatic language to sell the product. A critical reader would question the credibility of the second article before believing or sharing it.

#### Discussion Questions:

1. What clues in the case study suggest the blogger's article may be unreliable?
2. Suggest two questions a critical reader should ask before trusting online health information.

#### REFLECTION — Think About It

*Recall a piece of information you read online or heard from someone that turned out to be false or exaggerated. How could critical reading have helped you evaluate it earlier?*

 **Quick Check 2.5**

1. Distinguish between a fact and an opinion, giving one example of each.
2. State two clues that might suggest a text is biased.
3. Explain why critical reading is important when using the internet for research.

## End of TOPIC 2 Review Questions

Answer all questions. Refer to the Answer Key chapter at the end of this book to check your work after attempting all questions on your own.

1. Define reading fluency and state its three key components.
2. Give one example each of a collocation and a binomial.
3. Explain how previewing a text can help a reader make predictions about its content.
4. Distinguish between extensive reading and intensive reading.
5. Explain two strategies for guessing the meaning of unfamiliar words while reading.
6. Distinguish between skimming and scanning, giving a situation when each would be used.
7. State three good note-taking practices.
8. Explain why it is important to record sources when carrying out research.
9. Distinguish between fact and opinion, giving one example of each.
10. Explain two ways a reader can identify bias in a text.
11. A student is researching climate change for a class project. Advise them on how to use skimming, scanning and critical reading effectively during their research.

## Topic 2 Practical Worksheet: Reading Skills in Practice

Using a newspaper article or online article about the Environment or Technology theme (provided by your teacher), complete the following tasks individually, then discuss your answers in small groups.

### Tasks:

1. Skim the article and write one sentence summarising what it is generally about.
2. Scan the article to find and note down three specific facts (e.g. names, dates, figures).
3. Read the article intensively and answer three comprehension questions set by your teacher.
4. Identify one sentence that states a fact and one that expresses an opinion.
5. Write a short paragraph evaluating whether the article seems reliable and unbiased, giving reasons.

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**TOPIC 3****GRAMMAR IN USE**

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Grammar is the system of rules that gives structure and clarity to English. In this topic you will study word classes, phrases, clauses and sentence structure — the essential building blocks you need to speak and write accurately and confidently.



### 3.1 Word Classes (Parts of Speech)

Suggested Lessons: 15

**Key Inquiry Question:** *Why is it important to determine how a word is used in a sentence?*

By the end of this sub-topic, you should be able to:

- classify nouns, pronouns and determiners in sentences
- identify main verbs and auxiliary verbs, and inflect verbs for tense and aspect
- use adverbs of time, place and manner appropriately
- identify adjectives, simple prepositions and coordinating conjunctions
- use the various word classes correctly for effective communication

#### What Is a Word Class?

A word class (also called a part of speech) is a category of words that share similar grammatical properties. English has eight main word classes, plus determiners, which behave similarly to adjectives/pronouns but have a distinct grammatical role.

#### 1. Nouns

A noun names a person, place, thing or idea.

| Type of Noun   | Example                                        |
|----------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Common noun    | teacher, city, book                            |
| Proper noun    | Peter, Nairobi, Kenya                          |
| Concrete noun  | table, phone, dog                              |
| Abstract noun  | honesty, freedom, happiness                    |
| Count noun     | chair(s), idea(s) — can be counted             |
| Non-count noun | water, information, advice — cannot be counted |

#### 2. Pronouns and Determiners

A pronoun replaces a noun to avoid repetition. A determiner introduces a noun and specifies which one, or how many, is meant.

| Category               | Examples                          |
|------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Personal pronouns      | I, you, he, she, it, we, they     |
| Reflexive pronouns     | myself, yourself, himself         |
| Reciprocal pronouns    | each other, one another           |
| Demonstrative pronouns | this, that, these, those          |
| Relative pronouns      | who, which, that, whose           |
| Interrogative pronouns | who, what, which (in questions)   |
| Determiners            | the, a, this, my, some, many, two |

Note: the same word can act as a determiner or a pronoun depending on its role. E.g. 'That boy is tall' (that = determiner) vs 'That is new' (that = pronoun).

### 3. Verbs

A verb expresses an action, occurrence or state of being. Main verbs carry the core meaning; primary auxiliary verbs (be, have, do) support the main verb to show tense, aspect or form questions/negatives.

- Regular verbs form the past tense by adding -ed, e.g. walk → walked
- Irregular verbs change form unpredictably, e.g. go → went, eat → ate
- Phrasal verbs combine a verb with a preposition/adverb to create new meaning, e.g. give up, look after, break down

### 4. Adverbs

| Type             | Example                  | Answers the Question |
|------------------|--------------------------|----------------------|
| Adverb of time   | yesterday, soon, now     | When?                |
| Adverb of place  | here, there, outside     | Where?               |
| Adverb of manner | quickly, carefully, well | How?                 |

### 5. Adjectives, Prepositions and Conjunctions

- Adjectives describe nouns, e.g. a tall building, an interesting story. When several adjectives are used together, they usually follow an order: opinion, size, age, shape, colour, origin, material, purpose (e.g. 'a beautiful small old round brown Kenyan wooden table').
- Simple prepositions show relationships of place, time or direction, e.g. in, on, at, under, before, after.
- Coordinating conjunctions join words, phrases or clauses of equal rank: for, and, nor, but, or, yet, so (remembered by the acronym FANBOYS).

#### Did You Know?

English speakers unconsciously follow the correct adjective order (opinion-size-age-shape-colour-origin-material-purpose) almost automatically! Saying 'a red big house' instead of 'a big red house' sounds instantly wrong to a fluent speaker, even if they can't explain the rule.

#### Case Study: Word Classes in the World of Technology

Consider this sentence from a technology news article: 'The innovative Kenyan startup quickly launched a new mobile app.' Here 'innovative' and 'Kenyan' are adjectives describing 'startup' (a common noun), 'quickly' is an adverb of manner, and 'launched' is the main verb.

#### Discussion Questions:

1. Identify all the word classes in the sentence: 'She carefully uploaded the large digital file yesterday.'
2. Write two sentences of your own about the theme of Technology, using at least one noun, one verb, one adjective and one adverb.

#### REFLECTION — Think About It

Why do you think it is important to know the difference between how a word is used as a pronoun versus a determiner?

#### Quick Check 3.1

1. Classify the following nouns as common, proper, concrete or abstract: Nairobi, honesty, chair, doctor.
2. Identify the pronoun and the determiner in: 'That is my book, but this one is yours.'
3. State the past tense of the irregular verb 'go' and the regular verb 'walk'.

4. Write a sentence using an adverb of manner.
5. Name the seven coordinating conjunctions (FANBOYS).

## 3.2 Phrases

Suggested Lessons: 9

**Key Inquiry Question:** Why is it important to use phrases of varied structure in communication?

By the end of this sub-topic, you should be able to:

- identify the constituents of noun phrases and verb phrases
- analyse the constituents of adverb, adjective and prepositional phrases
- describe the functions of different types of phrases in sentences
- use different types of phrases correctly in varied contexts

### What Is a Phrase?

A phrase is a group of related words that acts as a single unit within a sentence but does not contain a full subject and verb (which would make it a clause).

### Types of Phrases

| Phrase Type          | Structure                             | Example                        |
|----------------------|---------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| Noun phrase (NP)     | Determiner + (Adjective) + Noun       | the tall building, a new phone |
| Verb phrase (VP)     | Main verb + auxiliary verb(s)         | has been working, will finish  |
| Adjective phrase     | (Intensifier) + Adjective             | very tall, extremely difficult |
| Adverb phrase        | Single adverb OR Intensifier + adverb | quickly, very carefully        |
| Prepositional phrase | Preposition + Noun Phrase/Adverb      | in the classroom, before noon  |

### Functions of Phrases in Sentences

- Noun phrases can act as the subject or object of a sentence, e.g. 'The tall building collapsed.'
- Verb phrases show the action and its tense/aspect, e.g. 'She has been studying all night.'
- Prepositional phrases often show place, time or manner, e.g. 'They met at the market before sunset.'

#### Did You Know?

A single well-constructed noun phrase can carry a lot of information! For example: 'the extremely talented young Kenyan athlete from Iten' is all one noun phrase, built by stacking modifiers before the head noun 'athlete'.

#### REFLECTION — Think About It

Write a sentence about your favourite sport or game (theme: Sports and Games) and identify the noun phrase, verb phrase and any prepositional phrase within it.

#### Quick Check 3.2

1. Identify the noun phrase in: 'The energetic young players won the match.'
2. Construct a verb phrase showing the present perfect continuous tense (e.g. has/have been + verb-ing).
3. Give an example of a prepositional phrase showing time.
4. Distinguish between an adjective phrase and an adverb phrase, giving one example of each.

### 3.3 Clauses

Suggested Lessons: 8

**Key Inquiry Question:** *Why do we need clauses in sentences, and why is it important to use a variety of clause types?*

By the end of this sub-topic, you should be able to:

- identify relative and adverbial clauses in sentences
- distinguish between defining and non-defining relative clauses
- identify noun clauses that begin with 'that' and 'what'
- use relative, adverbial and noun clauses correctly in varied contexts

#### What Is a Clause?

A clause is a group of words that contains both a subject and a verb. A main (independent) clause can stand alone as a complete sentence; a subordinate (dependent) clause cannot stand alone and depends on a main clause for its full meaning.

#### Relative Clauses

A relative clause gives more information about a noun, usually introduced by a relative pronoun (who, which, that, whose).

| Type                         | Feature                                                                                     | Example                                                   |
|------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| Defining relative clause     | Identifies exactly which noun is meant; no commas used                                      | The umbrella that I bought yesterday is red.              |
| Non-defining relative clause | Adds extra information; set off by commas; can be removed without changing the core meaning | My laptop, which I bought last year, has stopped working. |

#### Adverbial Clauses

An adverbial clause functions like an adverb, giving information about time, reason, condition, contrast or place, and is introduced by a subordinating conjunction.

| Type      | Subordinating Conjunctions        | Example                                       |
|-----------|-----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| Time      | when, while, before, after, until | She called me before she left the office.     |
| Reason    | because, since, as                | He was late because the matatu broke down.    |
| Condition | if, unless                        | We will go hiking if the weather is good.     |
| Contrast  | although, even though, whereas    | Although it was raining, the match continued. |

#### Noun Clauses

A noun clause functions like a noun in a sentence and often begins with 'that' or 'what'.

- 'That the team won was no surprise.' (noun clause as subject)
- 'I believe that hard work pays off.' (noun clause as object)
- 'What she said surprised everyone.' (noun clause as subject)

### Did You Know?

Leaving out a comma before a non-defining relative clause can completely change a sentence's meaning! Compare: 'My brother who lives in Mombasa is a doctor' (suggests you have more than one brother) vs 'My brother, who lives in Mombasa, is a doctor' (you have only one brother, and this extra detail is just additional information).

### Case Study: Clauses in Everyday Culture and Values

Consider the sentence: 'Respect, which is a core value in many Kenyan communities, is taught from a young age.' The non-defining relative clause 'which is a core value in many Kenyan communities' adds extra cultural context without changing the core message that respect is taught from a young age.

#### Discussion Questions:

1. Rewrite the case study sentence as two separate simple sentences.
2. Write one sentence about a cultural value using a defining relative clause, and one using an adverbial clause of reason.

### REFLECTION — Think About It

Why might using only simple sentences (without clauses) make your writing sound repetitive or less sophisticated?

### Quick Check 3.3

1. Distinguish between a defining and a non-defining relative clause.
2. Identify the adverbial clause in: 'We stayed indoors because it was raining heavily.' State what type it is.
3. Write a sentence containing a noun clause beginning with 'what'.
4. Explain why a subordinate clause cannot stand alone as a sentence.

### 3.4 Sentence Structure and Types

Suggested Lessons: 8

**Key Inquiry Question:** *How do the elements of a sentence affect communication, and how can we achieve variety in our sentences?*

By the end of this sub-topic, you should be able to:

- analyse basic clause patterns (SV, SVO, SVC, SVOO, SVOA) in simple sentences
- use simple and compound sentences in oral and written texts
- apply the rules of subject-verb agreement
- distinguish between and construct active and passive sentences

#### Basic Sentence Patterns

Every simple sentence in English is built around one of these basic patterns, based on the elements Subject (S), Verb (V), Object (O), Complement (C), and Adverbial (A):

| Pattern | Example                          |
|---------|----------------------------------|
| S V     | Birds fly.                       |
| S V O   | The girl read a book.            |
| S V C   | The soup tastes delicious.       |
| S V O O | She gave him a gift.             |
| S V O A | He placed the vase on the table. |

#### Simple and Compound Sentences

- A simple sentence has one independent clause: 'The team trained hard.'
- A compound sentence joins two or more independent clauses using a coordinating conjunction (FANBOYS) or a semicolon: 'The team trained hard, and they won the match.'

#### Subject-Verb Agreement

The verb in a sentence must agree in number with its subject: a singular subject takes a singular verb, and a plural subject takes a plural verb.

| Rule                                  | Example                               |
|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Singular subject → singular verb      | The doctor treats patients every day. |
| Plural subject → plural verb          | The doctors treat patients every day. |
| Collective nouns are usually singular | The team is playing well this season. |

#### Active and Passive Sentences

In an active sentence, the subject performs the action. In a passive sentence, the subject receives the action, often with the 'doer' introduced by 'by' or omitted altogether.

| Active                          | Passive                                  |
|---------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| The nurse treated the patient.  | The patient was treated by the nurse.    |
| Workers built the new hospital. | The new hospital was built (by workers). |

### Did You Know?

The passive voice is used deliberately in scientific and news writing when the 'doer' of an action is unknown, unimportant, or intentionally left out — for example, 'Three suspects were arrested' focuses attention on the suspects, not on who arrested them.

### Case Study: Sentence Variety in Health Communication

A public health poster on personal hygiene reads: 'Wash your hands regularly. Germs spread quickly through dirty hands, so always use soap and clean water. Hands should be washed for at least 20 seconds.' Notice the mix of simple sentences, a compound sentence, and a passive construction — this variety keeps the message clear yet engaging.

#### Discussion Questions:

1. Identify the compound sentence and the passive sentence in the case study text.
2. Rewrite the passive sentence in the case study in the active voice.

### REFLECTION — Think About It

Why do you think using only one type of sentence structure throughout a piece of writing might make it boring or hard to follow?

### Quick Check 3.4

1. Identify the sentence pattern of: 'The teacher gave the students homework.'
2. Correct the subject-verb agreement error: 'The group of students are studying hard.'
3. Change to passive voice: 'The chef prepared a delicious meal.'
4. Combine these two simple sentences into one compound sentence: 'It started to rain. We continued playing.'



## End of TOPIC 3 Review Questions

Answer all questions. Refer to the Answer Key chapter at the end of this book to check your work after attempting all questions on your own.

1. Classify the following words by word class: quickly, honesty, beneath, and, tall, they.
2. Distinguish between a common noun and a proper noun, giving one example of each.
3. State the difference between a pronoun and a determiner, with an example of each.
4. List the seven coordinating conjunctions.
5. Identify the noun phrase and the verb phrase in: 'The dedicated athlete has been training every morning.'
6. Distinguish between an adjective phrase and a prepositional phrase, giving an example of each.
7. Distinguish between a defining and a non-defining relative clause.
8. Write a sentence containing an adverbial clause of condition.
9. Explain the difference between a main clause and a subordinate clause.
10. Identify the sentence pattern (e.g. SVO, SVC) of: 'The children seem happy.'
11. Correct the following for subject-verb agreement: 'Neither of the boys were present.'
12. Rewrite in the passive voice: 'The government launched a new policy.'
13. Combine the following into one compound sentence: 'She studied hard. She passed her exams.'
14. Explain why using a variety of sentence types (simple, compound, active, passive) makes writing more effective.

## Topic 3 Practical Worksheet: Grammar Building Blocks

Complete the following exercises individually, then exchange your work with a partner for peer review.

### Tasks:

1. Write five sentences about the theme of Careers, each featuring a different word class underlined and labelled (noun, verb, adjective, adverb, preposition).
2. Construct three noun phrases and three prepositional phrases related to the theme of Travel.
3. Write two sentences containing relative clauses (one defining, one non-defining) about a place you have visited or would like to visit.
4. Write a short paragraph (4–5 sentences) about Sports and Games using at least one simple sentence, one compound sentence, and one sentence in the passive voice.
5. Exchange your paragraph with a partner and check each other's subject-verb agreement.

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**TOPIC 4****WRITING**

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Writing is a skill you will use throughout your education and career — from school essays to job applications and official correspondence. This topic covers sentence fluency, spelling and punctuation, effective paragraph writing, the full writing process, creative writing, and essential functional writing formats such as letters, reports, memos and meeting documents.

## 4.1 Sentence Fluency

Suggested Lessons: 4

**Key Inquiry Question:** *What can make a sentence confusing to a reader, and why should we write complete sentences?*

By the end of this sub-topic, you should be able to:

- contrast well-written sentences with comma splices, run-on sentences and run-on lines
- rewrite comma splices, run-on sentences and run-on lines as complete, correct sentences
- value the importance of well-written sentences for clear communication

### Common Sentence Errors

| Error Type                     | Example (Incorrect)                                                                       | Corrected                                                                |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Comma splice                   | I was tired, I went to bed early.                                                         | I was tired, so I went to bed early. / I was tired; I went to bed early. |
| Run-on sentence                | I was tired I went to bed early.                                                          | I was tired, so I went to bed early.                                     |
| Run-on lines (in poetry/prose) | Sentences that continue awkwardly across lines without clear breaks, confusing the reader | Break into clear, complete sentences with correct punctuation            |

### How to Fix These Errors

- Split the run-on into two separate sentences using a full stop
- Join the two ideas with a coordinating conjunction (and, but, so, etc.) after a comma
- Use a semicolon to join two closely related independent clauses
- Use a subordinating conjunction to turn one clause into a dependent clause

#### Did You Know?

A comma splice is one of the most common errors even among experienced writers! It happens because commas feel like a natural 'breathing pause' — but grammatically, a comma alone cannot join two complete sentences.

#### REFLECTION — Think About It

Why do you think unclear sentence structure (like a run-on sentence) could cause serious misunderstanding in a formal document, such as a contract or a set of instructions?

#### Quick Check 4.1

1. Define a comma splice and give an example.
2. Correct this run-on sentence: 'The rain started we cancelled the match.'
3. State two ways of correctly joining two independent clauses.

## 4.2 Mechanics of Writing: Spelling

Suggested Lessons: 4

**Key Inquiry Question:** *Why should we spell words correctly, and why do we use abbreviations and acronyms?*

By the end of this sub-topic, you should be able to:

- identify frequently misspelt and easily confused words
- use acronyms, abbreviations and commonly confused words correctly
- apply spelling rules for words with affixes
- appreciate the role of correct spelling in written communication

### Frequently Confused Words

| Word Pair               | Meaning/Use                                    |
|-------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| their / there / they're | possession / place / contraction of 'they are' |
| your / you're           | possession / contraction of 'you are'          |
| its / it's              | possession / contraction of 'it is'            |
| affect / effect         | verb (to influence) / noun (a result)          |
| stationary / stationery | not moving / writing materials                 |

### Abbreviations and Acronyms

- Abbreviation — a shortened form of a word or phrase, e.g. Dr. (Doctor), etc. (et cetera), Mr. (Mister)
- Acronym — a word formed from the initial letters of a phrase, pronounced as a word, e.g. NASA, KICD, UNESCO
- Initialism — similar to an acronym but pronounced letter by letter, e.g. FBI, ATM, KCSE

### Spelling Rules for Affixes

- Words ending in a single consonant preceded by a single vowel often double the consonant before adding -ing/-ed, e.g. stop → stopping, stopped
- Words ending in 'e' usually drop the 'e' before adding -ing, e.g. write → writing
- Words ending in a consonant + 'y' change 'y' to 'i' before adding -es or -ed (but not -ing), e.g. study → studies, studied, studying

#### Did You Know?

The word 'scuba' is actually an acronym: Self-Contained Underwater Breathing Apparatus! Many everyday English words started out as acronyms or abbreviations.

#### REFLECTION — Think About It

Why do you think correct spelling matters more in formal writing (like a job application) than in a casual text message to a friend?

#### Quick Check 4.2

1. Distinguish between 'their', 'there' and 'they're', using each correctly in a sentence.
2. Give one example each of an abbreviation and an acronym.

3. Apply the spelling rule to write the correct -ing form of 'run' and 'write'.

## 4.3 Mechanics of Writing: Punctuation

Suggested Lessons: 5

**Key Inquiry Question:** *Why is it important to punctuate a sentence correctly, and when should one use capital letters?*

By the end of this sub-topic, you should be able to:

- explain the punctuation principles of capitalisation, quotation marks, dashes, hyphens and slashes
- apply the rules of capitalisation and punctuation in sentences
- advocate the correct use of punctuation for effective communication

### Capitalisation Rules

- The first word of a sentence, e.g. 'The sun rose early.'
- Proper nouns — names of people, places, organisations, e.g. Nairobi, Kenya Institute of Curriculum Development
- Days, months and holidays, e.g. Monday, December, Jamhuri Day
- The pronoun 'I'
- Titles when they precede a name, e.g. President Ruto, Dr Wanjiru

### Other Key Punctuation Marks

| Mark                       | Use                                              | Example                                                 |
|----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Single quotation marks ' ' | Quoting within a quotation, or informal emphasis | She said, 'He called it a 'masterpiece'.'               |
| Double quotation marks " " | Direct speech or quoting exact words             | She said, "I will be there by noon."                    |
| Hyphen -                   | Joining compound words or word parts             | well-known, twenty-two, mother-in-law                   |
| Dash —/—                   | Marking a break in thought or adding emphasis    | The results — announced yesterday — surprised everyone. |
| Slash /                    | Showing alternatives                             | he/she, and/or                                          |

#### Did You Know?

A famous punctuation joke shows how a comma can save a life: 'Let's eat, Grandma!' vs 'Let's eat Grandma!' — punctuation genuinely changes meaning, sometimes dramatically!

#### REFLECTION — Think About It

Think of a message you once sent or read that was misunderstood because of missing or incorrect punctuation. What happened?

#### Quick Check 4.3

1. State three rules for capitalisation, each with an example.
2. Write a sentence correctly using a hyphen to join a compound word.
3. Explain the difference in use between single and double quotation marks.

## 4.4 Elements of Effective Writing and the Writing Process

Suggested Lessons: 8

**Key Inquiry Question:** *Why should we organise ideas logically in writing, and why is it important to follow the writing process?*

By the end of this sub-topic, you should be able to:

- use connectors of addition, similarity and contrast to build cohesion
- order ideas in a paragraph for coherence
- explain and apply the steps of the writing process
- appreciate the value of logically ordered, well-processed writing

### Cohesion: Using Connectors

| Function   | Connectors                                        |
|------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Addition   | furthermore, moreover, in addition, also          |
| Similarity | similarly, likewise, in the same way              |
| Contrast   | however, on the other hand, nevertheless, whereas |

### Paragraph Development

A well-developed paragraph has a topic sentence (the main idea), supporting sentences (details, examples, evidence), and often a concluding sentence that links back to the main idea or transitions to the next paragraph. Ideas should flow logically — chronologically, by importance, or by cause and effect.

### The Writing Process

| Stage         | What Happens                                                      |
|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Prewriting | Brainstorming ideas, planning, researching your topic             |
| 2. Drafting   | Writing a first version, focusing on getting ideas down           |
| 3. Revision   | Reviewing and improving content, organisation and clarity         |
| 4. Editing    | Correcting grammar, spelling, punctuation and sentence structure  |
| 5. Publishing | Producing the final, polished version to share with your audience |

#### Did You Know?

*Professional authors often rewrite a manuscript many times before publishing! Even skilled writers rely on the revision and editing stages — good writing is really re-writing.*

#### Case Study: Writing Process in Action — A Letter of Appreciation

A student wants to write a letter appreciating a mentor for career guidance (theme: Careers). At the prewriting stage, she lists reasons she is grateful. In drafting, she writes a rough letter. During revision, she reorders her points for better flow and adds a specific example. During editing, she checks her spelling and punctuation. Finally, she publishes the letter by printing and delivering it.

**Discussion Questions:**

1. Explain what could go wrong if the student skipped the editing stage.
2. Using the same five stages, plan (in bullet form) how you would write a letter of appreciation to someone in your own life.

**REFLECTION — Think About It**

*Which stage of the writing process do you find hardest — prewriting, drafting, revising, editing, or publishing? Why?*

A small green icon of a pencil, used to introduce the quick check section.**Quick Check 4.4**

1. Give an example each of a connector of addition and a connector of contrast.
2. State the five stages of the writing process in order.
3. Explain the difference between the 'revision' and 'editing' stages of writing.



## 4.5 Creative Writing

Suggested Lessons: 5

**Key Inquiry Question:** *How can we write an effective descriptive or narrative composition?*

By the end of this sub-topic, you should be able to:

- describe a person or scene using varied literary techniques
- write a descriptive narrative essay on a given topic
- use sensory details and verb derivations for literary effect
- advocate for the use of sensory details in descriptive writing

### Descriptive Essays

A descriptive essay creates a vivid picture in the reader's mind using sensory details — what can be seen, heard, smelt, tasted and felt.

- Similes — comparing using 'like' or 'as', e.g. 'as brave as a lion'
- Metaphors — direct comparison without 'like/as', e.g. 'the classroom was a zoo'
- Sensory language — appealing to the five senses, e.g. 'the sizzling aroma of roasting maize filled the air'

### Narrative Essays

A narrative essay tells a story with a clear plot: an introduction/orientation, rising action, a climax, and a resolution. Good narratives use vivid description, dialogue and a logical sequence of events.

### Verb Derivations

Many descriptive verbs are derived from other word classes (nouns or adjectives) to make writing more vivid, e.g. 'to shadow' (from the noun shadow), 'to calm' (from the adjective calm), 'to butter' (from the noun butter).



#### Did You Know?

Skilled writers often 'show, don't tell'. Instead of writing 'She was scared', a descriptive writer might write 'Her hands trembled and her breath caught in her throat' — letting sensory details show the emotion rather than simply naming it.



#### REFLECTION — Think About It

Think of a memorable place or event in your life. What sensory details (sounds, smells, sights) would you include if you wrote a descriptive essay about it?



#### Quick Check 4.5

1. Distinguish between a simile and a metaphor, giving one example of each.
2. List the five senses a descriptive essay could appeal to.
3. Outline the basic structure (plot elements) of a narrative essay.

## 4.6 Functional Writing

Suggested Lessons: 14

**Key Inquiry Question:** *Why is it important to write different types of formal documents correctly, and how can we ensure they are effective?*

By the end of this sub-topic, you should be able to:

- identify the appropriate format and content of letters of complaint, request and inquiry
- identify the elements of simple reports, memos and emails with attachments
- describe the features of a notice of a meeting, an agenda and minutes
- write various functional documents accurately for effective communication

### 1. Formal Letters: Complaint, Request and Inquiry

All formal letters share a similar structure: sender's address, date, recipient's address, salutation, subject heading, body (introduction, details, conclusion), complimentary close and signature.

| Letter Type         | Purpose                                                             | Key Content                                                                |
|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Letter of complaint | To express dissatisfaction and request a resolution                 | State the problem clearly, give evidence/details, state the desired action |
| Letter of request   | To formally ask for something (information, permission, assistance) | State what is being requested and why, be polite and specific              |
| Letter of inquiry   | To ask for information                                              | State clearly what information is needed and why                           |

### 2. Reports, Memos and Emails

| Document               | Key Features                                                                                                              |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Simple report          | Title, introduction, findings/body (often with headings), conclusion, recommendations                                     |
| Memo (memorandum)      | To:, From:, Date:, Subject:, followed by a brief, direct message — used for internal communication within an organisation |
| Email with attachments | Clear subject line, polite greeting, concise body, mention of attachment, polite closing, signature                       |

### 3. Meeting Documents: Notice, Agenda and Minutes

| Document            | Key Features                                                                                                                                              |
|---------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Notice of a meeting | States the date, time, venue and purpose of an upcoming meeting; issued in advance                                                                        |
| Agenda              | Lists the items to be discussed in the order they will be handled, often starting with 'Preliminaries' and ending with 'Any Other Business (A.O.B.)'      |
| Minutes             | An official written record of what was discussed and decided at a meeting, including attendance, matters arising, resolutions and the next meeting's date |

**Did You Know?**

*In many organisations, minutes of a meeting are considered a legal record — they can be referred to later to confirm exactly what was agreed and who was responsible for each action point!*

**Case Study: Functional Writing in Income Generation**

A young entrepreneur running a small business (theme: Income: Types and Sources) needs to write a letter of inquiry to a supplier about wholesale prices, a memo to her two employees about new opening hours, and later, minutes for a meeting where they plan to expand the business. Each document requires a different tone and format, but all must be clear, accurate and professional.

**Discussion Questions:**

1. Draft a short letter of inquiry from the entrepreneur to the supplier, following the correct format.
2. Draft a brief memo to the employees announcing the new opening hours.

**REFLECTION — Think About It**

*Why do you think using the correct, professional format for functional documents like letters and memos matters, even when the message itself is simple?*

**Quick Check 4.6**

1. State three key contents that should appear in a letter of complaint.
2. List the standard headings found at the top of a memo.
3. Distinguish between a notice of a meeting and an agenda.
4. State what should be recorded in the minutes of a meeting.

## End of TOPIC 4 Review Questions

Answer all questions. Refer to the Answer Key chapter at the end of this book to check your work after attempting all questions on your own.

1. Define a comma splice and correct this example: 'The bus was late, we missed the meeting.'
2. Distinguish between 'affect' and 'effect', using each correctly in a sentence.
3. Give an example each of an abbreviation and an acronym.
4. State three rules of capitalisation.
5. Explain the difference between a hyphen and a dash, giving an example of each.
6. Name and briefly explain the five stages of the writing process.
7. Give one connector each for addition, similarity and contrast.
8. Distinguish between a simile and a metaphor, giving an example of each.
9. Outline the basic structure of a narrative essay.
10. State the key content that should be included in a letter of complaint.
11. Distinguish between a memo and an email with attachments.
12. Describe the difference between a notice of a meeting and the minutes of a meeting.
13. A school club needs to hold its first meeting. Draft, in outline form, the key parts of a notice of the meeting and a simple agenda.
14. Explain why editing is an essential stage in the writing process, even after a good first draft has been written.

## Topic 4 Practical Worksheet: Applying the Writing Process

Choose ONE of the following functional writing tasks related to the theme of Health and Safety. Follow the full writing process (prewriting, drafting, revision, editing, publishing) to complete it.

### Tasks:

1. Option A: Write a letter of complaint to a local water company about an unsafe, contaminated water supply in your estate.
2. Option B: Write a memo to students informing them of new health and safety rules in the school laboratory.
3. Option C: Write the notice and agenda for a school health club meeting to plan a health awareness day.
4. For whichever option you choose: (1) list your brainstormed ideas (prewriting), (2) write a first draft, (3) revise it with a partner's feedback, (4) edit for grammar, spelling and punctuation, and (5) write out your final, 'published' version neatly.
5. Underline and label at least one example each of a comma, a hyphen, and a correctly capitalised proper noun in your final version.

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## ANSWER KEY

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This chapter provides model answers to all the Quick Check questions and End of Topic Review Questions in this book. Use it to check your own work — remember, some answers (especially longer explanations) can be correctly expressed in different words.

## Quick Check Answers

### Quick Check 1.1

1. Extensive listening is listening broadly for overall enjoyment/understanding (e.g. a story); intensive listening is listening closely for specific detailed information (e.g. exact figures in a news bulletin).
2. E.g. listening for your name/flight number at an airport while ignoring other announcements.
3. Critical listening helps you identify the advertiser's persuasive techniques, bias or exaggerated claims rather than accepting the message at face value.
4. Any two: focus attention and avoid distractions; listen for key/signal words; take brief notes; avoid interrupting; reflect before responding.

### Quick Check 1.2

1. Non-verbal cues are ways of communicating without words, e.g. facial expressions, gestures, posture.
2. Any three: facial expressions, gestures, eye contact, posture, proxemics, tone of voice.
3. Because cultural norms differ — direct eye contact is respectful in some cultures but disrespectful (e.g. to elders) in others.

### Quick Check 1.3

1. E.g. 'record' — RE-cord (noun, a music record) vs re-CORD (verb, to record something).
2. Synonym: words with similar meaning, e.g. happy/glad. Antonym: opposite meaning, e.g. hot/cold. Homophone: same sound, different meaning/spelling, e.g. sea/see.
3. 'Sheep' uses the long vowel /i:/ while 'ship' uses the short vowel /ɪ/ — the vowel length changes the word's meaning entirely.

### Quick Check 1.4

1. Any two: greet politely, identify yourself, speak clearly, avoid interrupting, end politely.
2. E.g. 'By the way...', 'That reminds me...', 'On a different note...'
3. The chairperson opens the meeting, previous minutes are read/confirmed, the agenda is followed item by item, action points are recorded, and the meeting is closed.

### Quick Check 1.5

1. Speaking fluency is speaking smoothly, accurately and expressively at an appropriate pace without unnecessary hesitation.
2. Any two: practise speaking/reading aloud regularly; organise thoughts before speaking; use varied vocabulary; match pace to audience.
3. Using synonyms avoids repetitive, monotonous speech and keeps the listener engaged.

### Quick Check 2.1

1. Reading fluency is reading a text accurately, at an appropriate speed, and expressively.
2. Adverb+adjective: e.g. 'completely satisfied'. Noun+noun: e.g. 'a surge of anger'.
3. Reading aloud helps a reader practise correct pacing, pronunciation, expression and use of punctuation, which builds fluency.

**Quick Check 2.2**

1. Extensive reading is reading widely, often for pleasure or general understanding, rather than close study.
2. It activates prior knowledge and helps the reader anticipate content, improving comprehension and engagement.
3. Contrast: 'however'. Sequence: 'firstly' (or 'finally').

**Quick Check 2.3**

1. Extensive reading is wide, general reading for overall understanding; intensive reading is close, detailed reading of a shorter text for specific meaning.
2. Using context clues — looking at surrounding words, examples, definitions or contrast words to infer meaning.
3. It helps the reader follow the overall structure and argument of the text before focusing on smaller details.

**Quick Check 2.4**

1. Skimming is reading quickly for a general idea; scanning is reading quickly to find specific information (e.g. a date or keyword).
2. Any two: use headings/bullet points; use abbreviations/symbols consistently; highlight key terms.
3. So that the source can be verified/checked for reliability and properly credited (avoiding plagiarism).

**Quick Check 2.5**

1. A fact can be proven true or false (e.g. 'Kenya is in East Africa'); an opinion reflects a personal belief (e.g. 'Kenya has the best scenery in Africa').
2. Any two: emotionally loaded language; only one side of an argument presented; lack of credible sources.
3. Because the internet contains both reliable and unreliable/false information, and critical reading helps the reader evaluate credibility before trusting or sharing it.

**Quick Check 3.1**

1. Nairobi – proper; honesty – abstract; chair – concrete/common; doctor – common.
2. 'This' = pronoun (this one is yours); 'my' = determiner (my book).
3. 'go' → 'went' (irregular); 'walk' → 'walked' (regular).
4. E.g. 'She sang beautifully.'
5. For, And, Nor, But, Or, Yet, So.

**Quick Check 3.2**

1. 'The energetic young players' is the noun phrase.
2. E.g. 'has been studying' / 'have been working'.
3. E.g. 'before noon', 'since morning'.
4. Adjective phrase describes a noun/adjective, e.g. 'very tall'; adverb phrase modifies a verb/adjective/adverb, e.g. 'very carefully'.

**Quick Check 3.3**

1. A defining relative clause identifies exactly which noun is meant (no commas); a non-defining relative clause adds extra, non-essential information (set off by commas).
2. 'because it was raining heavily' — an adverbial clause of reason.
3. E.g. 'What she said surprised everyone.'

4. Because it does not express a complete thought on its own and depends on the main clause for full meaning.

### Quick Check 3.4

1. SVOO (Subject-Verb-Object-Object): The teacher (S) gave (V) the students (O) homework (O).
2. 'The group of students is studying hard.' (group is singular)
3. 'A delicious meal was prepared by the chef.'
4. 'It started to rain, but we continued playing.'

### Quick Check 4.1

1. A comma splice joins two independent clauses with only a comma, e.g. 'I was tired, I went to bed.'
2. 'The rain started, so we cancelled the match.'
3. Use a full stop to separate them into two sentences, or join them with a comma + coordinating conjunction, or a semicolon.

### Quick Check 4.2

1. 'Their' shows possession (their book), 'there' shows place (over there), 'they're' is a contraction of 'they are' (they're happy).
2. Abbreviation: e.g. 'Dr.'. Acronym: e.g. 'NASA'.
3. 'run' → 'running' (double the consonant); 'write' → 'writing' (drop the 'e').

### Quick Check 4.3

1. Any three: first word of a sentence; proper nouns; days/months; the pronoun 'I'; titles before names — each with an example.
2. E.g. 'She lives in a well-known estate.'
3. Double quotation marks are used for direct speech/exact quotes; single quotation marks are often used for a quote within a quote, or informally for emphasis.

### Quick Check 4.4

1. Addition: 'furthermore'/'in addition'. Contrast: 'however'/'on the other hand'.
2. Prewriting, Drafting, Revision, Editing, Publishing.
3. Revision focuses on improving content, organisation and clarity of ideas; editing focuses on correcting grammar, spelling and punctuation.

### Quick Check 4.5

1. A simile compares using 'like'/'as' (e.g. 'as brave as a lion'); a metaphor compares directly without 'like/as' (e.g. 'the classroom was a zoo').
2. Sight, hearing, smell, taste, touch.
3. Introduction/orientation, rising action, climax, resolution.

### Quick Check 4.6

1. Any three: a clear statement of the problem, supporting details/evidence, the desired resolution/action requested.
2. To:, From:, Date:, Subject:.



3. A notice of a meeting informs people in advance of the date, time, venue and purpose of a meeting; an agenda lists the specific items to be discussed during the meeting.
4. Attendance, matters arising from the previous meeting, discussions and resolutions made, and the date of the next meeting.

## End of Topic Review Question Answers

### Topic 1: Listening and Speaking

1. Extensive listening: listening broadly for enjoyment/understanding, e.g. a story. Critical listening: evaluating the message/bias, e.g. an advertisement.
2. It helps the listener filter out background noise and focus only on relevant information, e.g. listening for one's name at a busy airport.
3. Non-verbal cues are ways of communicating without words. Examples: facial expressions, gestures, eye contact.
4. Cultural norms about politeness and respect differ; a gesture seen as respectful in one culture may be seen as rude in another.
5. /ɒ/ is a short vowel sound, e.g. 'hot'; /ɔ:/ is a longer vowel sound, e.g. 'thought'.
6. Some two-syllable words change stress to change word class, e.g. RE-cord (noun) vs re-CORD (verb).
7. Synonym: similar meaning (happy/glad). Antonym: opposite meaning (hot/cold). Homophone: same sound, different spelling/meaning (sea/see).
8. Any three: greet politely, identify yourself, speak clearly, avoid interrupting, end the call politely.
9. Call to order, read/confirm previous minutes, follow the agenda item by item, record action points, close the meeting.
10. Any two: 'By the way...', 'That reminds me...', 'On a different note...'
11. Speaking fluency is speaking smoothly, accurately and expressively at an appropriate pace. Improve by practising regularly and organising thoughts before speaking.
12. Listening: practise intensive listening to catch exact details of questions; use responsive listening to answer appropriately. Speaking: speak fluently and confidently; use appropriate etiquette and non-verbal cues (eye contact, posture).

### Topic 2: Reading

1. Reading fluency is reading a text accurately, at an appropriate speed, and expressively.
2. Collocation: 'a surge of anger' (noun+noun). Binomial: 'safe and sound'.
3. It allows the reader to predict content and activate prior knowledge, improving comprehension.
4. Extensive reading is wide reading for general understanding/enjoyment; intensive reading is close reading of a shorter text for specific detail.
5. Any two: use context clues (surrounding words/examples); look for a definition or contrast word nearby.
6. Skimming: reading quickly for a general idea (used when previewing a whole chapter). Scanning: reading quickly to find a specific detail (used to find a date or name).
7. Any three: use headings, use bullet points/abbreviations, highlight key terms.
8. So the source can be verified for reliability and credited properly (avoiding plagiarism).
9. Fact: can be proven true/false, e.g. 'Kenya is in East Africa'. Opinion: a personal belief, e.g. 'Kenya has the best scenery'.
10. Any two: emotionally loaded language; presenting only one side of an argument.
11. Skim sources first to check relevance, scan for specific facts/statistics, then read critically to check for bias, reliability and evidence before including information in the project.

### Topic 3: Grammar in Use

1. quickly – adverb; honesty – noun; beneath – preposition; and – conjunction; tall – adjective; they – pronoun.
2. Common noun: general name, e.g. 'city'. Proper noun: specific name, e.g. 'Nairobi'.
3. A pronoun replaces a noun (e.g. 'it'); a determiner introduces a noun (e.g. 'the', 'my').
4. For, And, Nor, But, Or, Yet, So.
5. Noun phrase: 'The dedicated athlete'. Verb phrase: 'has been training'.

6. Adjective phrase describes a noun, e.g. 'very tall'. Prepositional phrase shows relationships of place/time, e.g. 'in the stadium'.
7. Defining relative clause identifies which noun is meant (no commas); non-defining adds extra information (set off by commas).
8. E.g. 'If the weather improves, we will go hiking.'
9. A main clause can stand alone as a sentence; a subordinate clause cannot and depends on a main clause.
10. SVC (Subject-Verb-Complement): The children (S) seem (V) happy (C).
11. 'Neither of the boys was present.' (neither is singular)
12. 'A new policy was launched by the government.'
13. 'She studied hard, and she passed her exams.'
14. Sentence variety keeps writing engaging, emphasises different information, and avoids monotony that would result from repeating the same structure.

#### Topic 4: Writing

1. A comma splice joins two independent clauses with only a comma. Correction: 'The bus was late, so we missed the meeting.'
2. 'Affect' is a verb meaning to influence, e.g. 'The rain will affect the match.' 'Effect' is a noun meaning a result, e.g. 'The effect of the rain was a delayed match.'
3. Abbreviation: e.g. 'Mr.'. Acronym: e.g. 'KICD'.
4. Any three: capitalise the first word of a sentence; proper nouns; the pronoun 'I' — each with an example.
5. A hyphen joins compound words, e.g. 'well-known'; a dash marks a break in thought or adds emphasis, e.g. 'The results — announced yesterday — surprised everyone.'
6. Prewriting (planning/brainstorming), Drafting (writing a first version), Revision (improving content/organisation), Editing (correcting grammar/spelling/punctuation), Publishing (producing the final version).
7. Addition: 'furthermore'. Similarity: 'likewise'. Contrast: 'however'.
8. Simile compares using 'like/as', e.g. 'as brave as a lion'. Metaphor compares directly, e.g. 'the classroom was a zoo'.
9. Introduction/orientation, rising action, climax, resolution.
10. A clear statement of the problem, supporting details/evidence, and the desired resolution/action requested.
11. A memo is used for brief internal communication with a fixed To/From/Date/Subject format; an email with attachments includes a subject line, greeting, body, and reference to an attached file, and can be sent externally or internally.
12. A notice of a meeting is issued in advance to inform people of date/time/venue/purpose; minutes are the official record of what was discussed and decided during the meeting itself.
13. Notice: should state the date, time, venue and purpose of the meeting. Agenda: should list items to be discussed such as Preliminaries, Reports, Health Day planning, and Any Other Business (A.O.B.).
14. Editing catches grammar, spelling and punctuation errors that could confuse the reader or appear unprofessional, even if the content and ideas (addressed at the revision stage) are already strong.